



C U S T O M E R I N S I G H T S J O U R N E Y S

The Good, The Bad, and The Useful.

A 15-minute reality check on Dynamics 365 marketing automation.



About me



Martin P Lopez

Independent Dynamics 365 & Power Platform Specialist

- Based in Switzerland
- 8 Years involved in Dynamics 365 and Power Platform projects
- In love with Customer Insights Journeys 🧡



[Martin P Lopez - LinkedIn](#)

What we'll cover

15 minutes · 3 acts

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| 1 | What is Customer Insights Journeys? | Positioning & where it lives in Dynamics 365 |
| 2 | Core capabilities | Events · Journeys · Emails & Forms |
| 3 | The Good | What truly works well in real projects |
| 4 | The Bad | Where reality drifts from the demo |
| 5 | The Useful | Tips I wish someone had told me earlier |

From Marketing to Journeys

Same surface, completely re-architected for real-time.



Dynamics 365 Marketing

Batch · scheduled · outbound



Customer Insights - Journeys

Real-time · trigger-based · Dataverse-native

Re-architected around the customer's behavior, not the marketer's calendar.

Four pillars of Journeys

01

Events

Plan, register, run.

02

Segments

Audience-defined flows.

03

Triggers

Real-time, event-driven.

04

Engagement

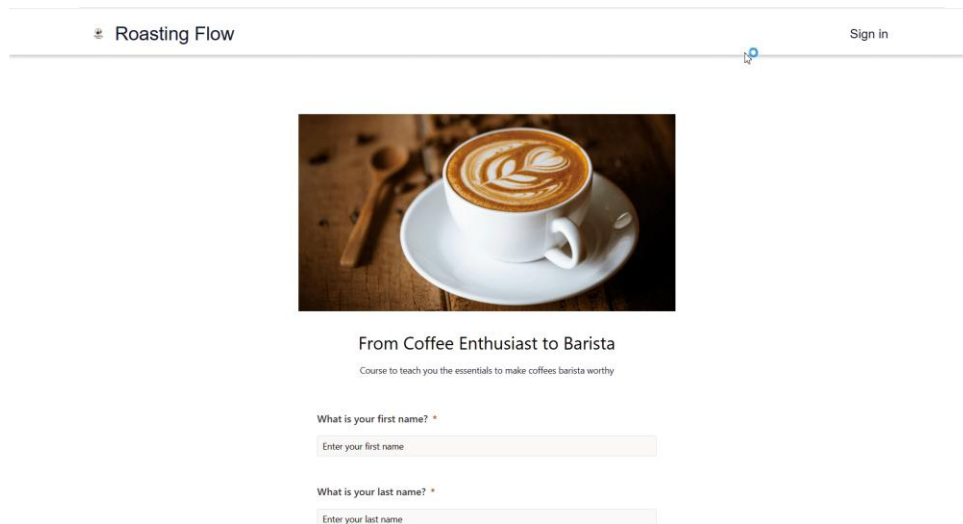
Emails, forms, brand.

Each pillar is a separate "surface", they share the same contact/lead/account spine in Dataverse.

Event Management

Plan it, fill it, run it without leaving Dynamics.

- Sessions, speakers, venues, sponsors
- Registration forms with waitlist
- Check-In Mobile App
- Native Microsoft Teams integration



Segment vs Trigger journeys

Two fundamentally different mental models. Pick the right one.

SEGMENT-BASED

Audience first.

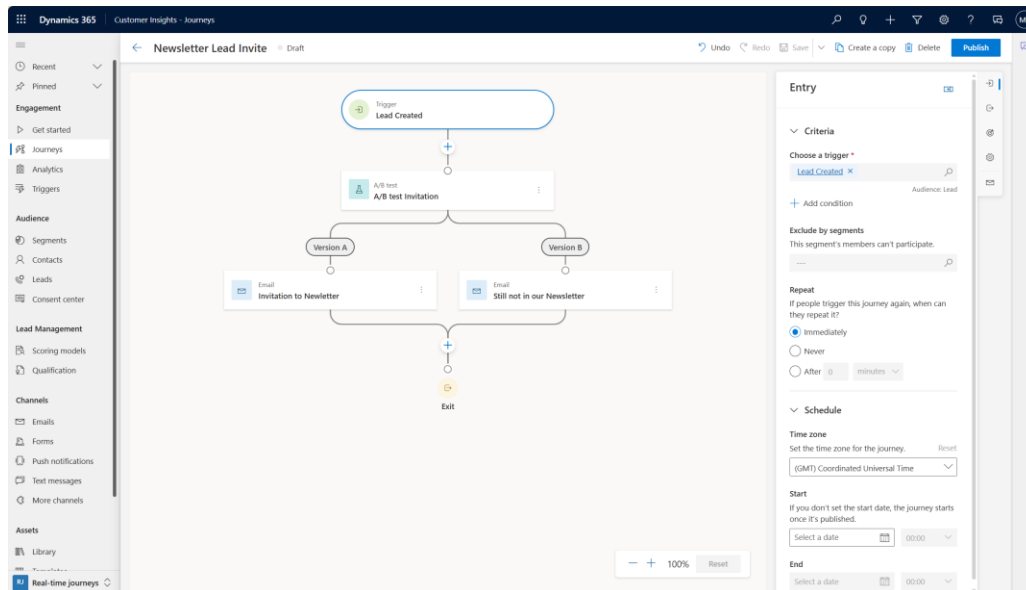
- Define a segment of contacts/leads
- Best for: nurture, newsletters, campaigns

TRIGGER-BASED

Event first.

- Starts on a real-time business / custom trigger
- Best for: transactional, behavior-driven flows

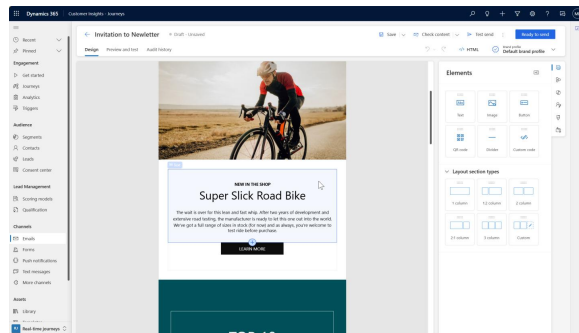
What a good journey looks like



Emails, forms & brand engagement

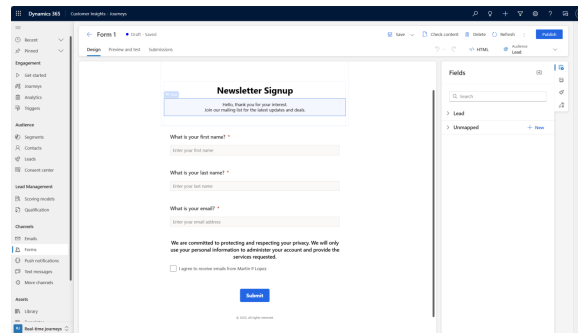
EMAILS

Drag-and-drop designer



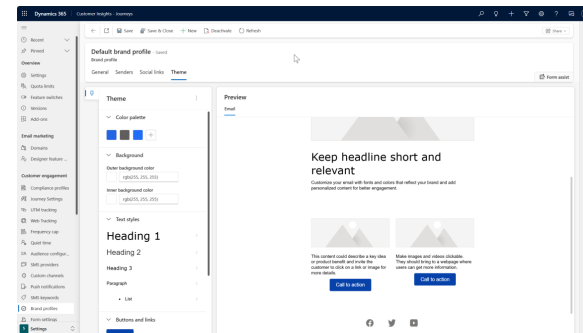
FORMS

Embeddable forms



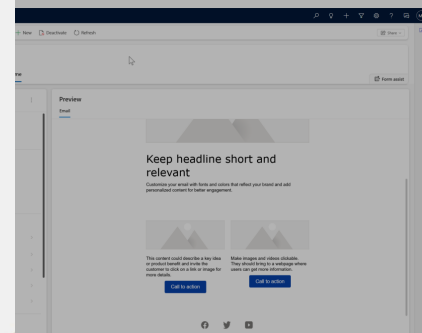
BRAND

Brand & consent center



The screenshot displays the Dynamics 365 Customer Insights Journeys interface. The top navigation bar shows 'Dynamics 365' and 'Customer Insights - Journeys'. The main workspace is titled 'Invitation to Newsletter' and is in 'Draft - Unsaved' state. The interface includes a left sidebar with navigation options: Recent, Pinned, Engagement (Get started, Journeys, Analytics, Triggers), Audience (Segments, Contacts, Leads, Consent center), Lead Management (Scoring models, Qualification), Channels (Emails, Forms, Push notifications, Text messages, More channels), and Assets (Library). The main content area shows an email design canvas with a header image of a cyclist, a section titled 'NEW IN THE SHOP Super Slick Road Bike' with a 'LEARN MORE' button, and a footer section. The right sidebar contains an 'Elements' panel with options for Text, Image, Button, QR code, Divider, and Custom code, and a 'Layout section types' panel with options for 1 column, 1:2 column, 2 column, 2:1 column, 3 column, and Custom. The top right of the canvas has buttons for 'Save', 'Check content', 'Test send', and 'Ready to send', along with a 'Brand profile' dropdown set to 'Default brand profile'.

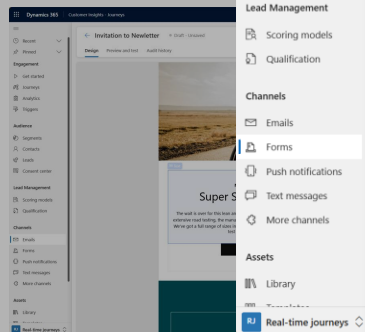
consent center



Emails

EMAILS

Drag-and-d



Dynamics 365 | Customer Insights - Journeys

Form 1 • Draft - Saved

Save Check content Delete Refresh Publish

Design Preview and test Submissions

HTML Audience Lead

Newsletter Signup

Hello, thank you for your interest.
Join our mailing list for the latest updates and deals.

What is your first name? *

Enter your first name

What is your last name? *

Enter your last name

What is your email? *

Enter your email address

We are committed to protecting and respecting your privacy. We will only use your personal information to administer your account and provide the services requested.

☐ I agree to receive emails from Martin P Lopez

Submit

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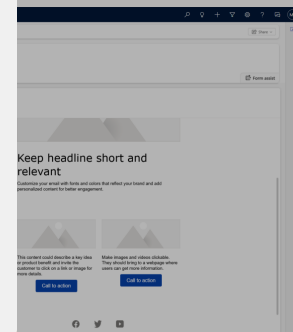
Fields

Search

Lead

Unmapped + New

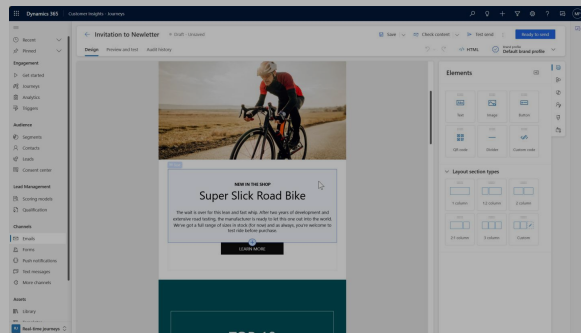
nt center



Emails, forms & brand engagement

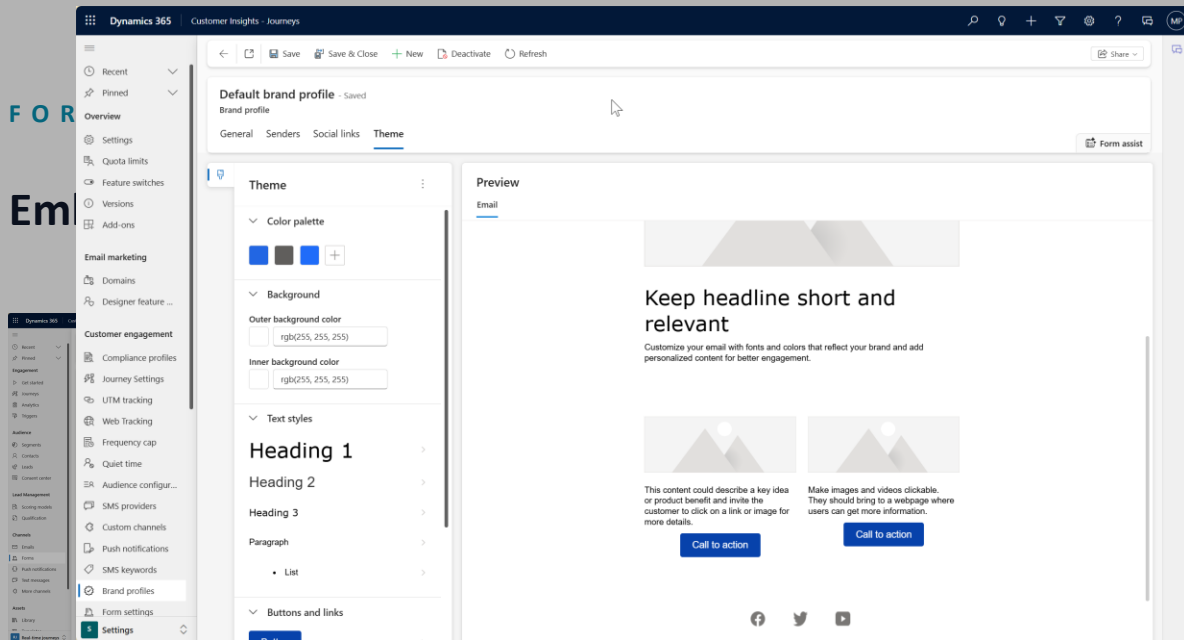
EMAILS

Drag-and-drop designer



FORMS

Email



THE GOOD

Where Journeys actually delivers.

● Real-time triggers

Reacting to behavior in seconds changes what marketing can do. And they're expandable

● Native to Dataverse

Access to Dataverse contacts and leads, plugins, Power Automate. No integrations needed.

● Microsoft Teams events out of the box

Webinars, registration, attendance handled without a third-party stack.

● Reusable building blocks

Brand profiles, content blocks, journey templates scale across business units.

THE BAD

Where reality drifts from the demo.

● Drag-and-drop ≠ designed

Stitching steps in the canvas hides logic, race conditions and unintended loops.

● Consent & GDPR is on YOU

Out-of-the-box consent rarely matches the client's legal reality. Plan for it day one.

● Migration from old Marketing

(For clients still in outbound Marketing) Most journeys, segments and forms must be rebuilt. Don't promise lift-and-shift.

● Multi-language & branding

One email = one language. Multi-brand, multi-country gets complex fast.

THE USEFUL

Tips I wish someone had told me earlier.

● Use a custom trigger catalogue

Define the business events ONCE. Journeys then become stable contracts, not spaghetti.

● Define a consent matrix

Channel × purpose × topic. Map it before you draw a single journey.

● Treat content blocks like code

Version them, name them, document them. Drag-and-drop chaos is real.

● When in doubt, use a trigger

If you can't decide between a segment-based journey or a trigger-based journey, trigger-based journey tend to work better for similar use cases

Takeaways

1

Very powerful, but opinionated.

Journeys is great if you embrace its real-time, Dataverse-native model.

2

Plan beyond the out-of-the-box.

Consent, branding, multilingual → all live outside the drag-and-drop.

3

Reuse beats reinvent.

Triggers, content blocks and templates are how teams actually scale.



Thank you.

Questions?



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